

SOC Incident Response Report

Phishing Email with External Link Access

Incident Metadata

Incident ID	THM-SOC-004
Incident Type	Phishing Email with External Link Access
Severity	Medium
Status	Closed
Date of Analysis	2026-02-05
Analyst	Prit Gujarati

Disclaimer
This incident report is based on historical log data. The attack timeline reflects actual event timestamps, while SOC response actions may be simulated for training purposes.

1. Executive Summary

A phishing alert was generated for an inbound email impersonating Microsoft security notifications. The email contained a suspicious external link using a typosquatted domain. Investigation confirmed that an internal endpoint accessed the embedded URL, and the outbound HTTPS connection was allowed by the firewall. No malware payload or attachment was observed; however, credential harvesting risk exists. Further endpoint and account investigation is required.

2. Incident Overview

Field	Details
Attack Vector	Phishing (Credential Harvesting)
Target System	User Email & Workstation
Target Account	c.allen@thetrydaily.thm
Detection Method	Email Security Gateway
Data Source	Email Logs & Firewall Logs
MITRE ATT&CK	T1566.002 – Phishing: Link

3. Attack Timeline (Log-Derived)

Based strictly on log timestamps

Time (UTC)	Event Description
06:21:52.511	Inbound phishing email detected
06:23:01.511	User clicked embedded phishing link
06:23:01.511	Outbound HTTPS connection allowed by firewall

4. Detection & Evidence

Detection Logic:

≥5 failed SSH login attempts
Followed by ≥1 successful login
From the same source IP and user
Within a short time window

Evidence:

Failed password for kali from 10.89.146.71
Accepted password for kali from 10.89.146.71

Log Fields Used:

src_ip: 10.89.146.71
user: kali
sourcetype: linux_auth
source: auth.log

5. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Phishing Domain	m1crosoftsupport.co
Phishing URL	https://m1crosoftsupport.co/login
Sender Email	no-reply@m1crosoftsupport.co
Destination IP	45.148.10.131
Source IP	10.20.2.25

6. Technical Analysis

The email used a typosquatted domain to impersonate Microsoft and create urgency by claiming suspicious login activity. The embedded URL redirected the user to an external HTTPS site, likely designed for credential harvesting. Firewall logs confirm that the link was accessed and allowed. While no malware download was detected, the possibility of credential compromise cannot be ruled out.

7. SOC Response Timeline

Reconstructed SOC response actions

Time (UTC)	Action Taken
06:22	Phishing alert generated by email security
06:23	Firewall logs correlated with email alert
06:25	SOC analyst initiated investigation

8. Impact Assessment

Potential credential exposure
No malware execution observed
User interaction confirmed
Further investigation required

9. Mitigation Actions

Block phishing domain at firewall and proxy
Reset affected user credentials
Invalidate active sessions
Hunt for additional clicks across environment

10. Recommendations

Enable advanced phishing protection
Implement URL rewriting and sandboxing
Conduct user phishing awareness training
Create SIEM correlation for email + firewall click events

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique Name
Initial Access	T1566.002	Phishing: Link

12. Conclusion

This incident demonstrates a successful phishing delivery with confirmed user interaction. While no immediate malware activity was detected, the event represents a credential compromise risk. Prompt remediation and user education are critical to preventing escalation.

Appendix

Log Sources: Email Gateway, Firewall

Detection Type: Phishing Alert with Network Correlation

Analysis Type: Email + Network Investigation

Report Purpose: SOC Portfolio